



THE COCKPIT

Following typical RAF practice for the time, the Spitfire's cockpit featured a central, "Basic Six" group instrument panel comprising airspeed indicator, artificial horizon, vertical speed indicator, altimeter, heading indicator, and turn-and-slip indicator. Engine instruments were to the right, and oxygen/undercarriage/flaps and other instruments to the left. The cockpit had no floor—just rudder pedals on which to rest the feet, with structure and systems beneath.

15. Instrument panel (with modern avionics in place of gun sight)
 16. Control-column, with gun-button at top 17. Undercarriage selector 18. Rudder pedal 19. Gun-camera indicator 20. Pilot's bucket-seat with height adjustment lever 21. Headrest and armor